

CMU MSA Brand Guide

Owner: Muslim Student Association of Carnegie Mellon University (CMU MSA)

Document type: Single source of truth for brand, communications, and visual-design standards

Audience: Executive boards, volunteers, and anyone maintaining digital platforms or creating visual materials (present and future)

Status: Living document maintained by the CMU MSA board.

Maintenance note. Carnegie Mellon University has strict rules about how student clubs can use the CMU name and logos (see Section 2). Because the university updates these rules from time to time, the MSA board must check with the CMU SLICE office and the university brand team at the start of every school year to make sure this guide is still up to date with university policy.

Scope. This brand guide is **web-first** and also governs the organization's **digital and social presence** — website, social media, Open Graph share cards, and digital flyers. It does **not** yet cover physical print or merchandise production (CMYK/Pantone separations, garment specs, etc.). Those were intentionally deferred and will be added when the organization is ready; their absence is a scoping decision, not an oversight.

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Section 1 — Executive Strategy & Linguistic Identity

1.1 Mission, Goals & Vision

Mission (official — from the MSA Constitution). The Muslim Student Association at Carnegie Mellon University strives to address the religious, cultural, and social needs of Muslim students, and to build awareness and familiarity with Islam, Islamic cultures, and Muslims through positive interactions with the broader CMU community.

This is the canonical mission statement. It is reproduced verbatim on the About page of MSA websites and in formal documents; do not paraphrase or rewrite it without approval from the MSA board.

Current goals. The MSA's stated goals are to continue advocating for Muslim students on campus and to ensure their spiritual, religious, social, and educational needs are met as fully as possible; to grow membership through campus outreach and strengthen connections with other Muslim organizations across Pittsburgh; and to continue and steadily expand the organization's charitable work on campus over time.

Goals are reviewed and may be updated by each incoming Board; revise this paragraph when the year's goals change.

Vision (elaboration, consistent with the mission). We aspire to be a steady home on campus: a place a first-year student can walk into on their first day and feel they belong, and a place a graduating senior remembers as central to who they became. We envision a CMU where Muslim students never have to choose between excelling in a demanding program and practicing their faith fully, and where the broader community knows the MSA as a generous, principled, and reliable neighbor. This vision is supporting language, not a substitute for the official mission above.

Values. Five commitments guide every decision the organization makes:

- **Hospitality** — We meet people with warmth before we ask anything of them. No one should feel like an outsider at an MSA event.
- **Knowledge** — We honor both sacred learning and academic rigor, and we treat curiosity as a virtue rather than a threat.
- **Service** — We give to our campus and our city, and we measure ourselves by what we contribute, not only by what we host.
- **Integrity** — We are honest in our communications, careful with members' trust, and transparent with the funds and platforms entrusted to us.
- **Inclusion** — We welcome every background, culture, and level of practice, and we design our spaces so that the newest and least certain person is as comfortable as the most observant.

1.2 Editorial Tone of Voice

The MSA writes in one consistent voice — warm, clear, and respectful — but adjusts register across three tiers. The unifying rule: never condescending, never preachy, never stiff. Plain modern English. Avoid

internal jargon when addressing a general audience, and define any religious term on first use in public-facing copy.

Tier 1 — Formal Administration (emails to faculty, SLICE, donors, sponsors, university offices). Tone is professional, courteous, and concise. Use complete sentences, a clear subject line, a named greeting, and a signature block with the writer’s role. State the purpose in the first two sentences. Avoid slang, emoji, and exclamation points. Be specific about dates, amounts, and requests. Close with a clear next step and a thank-you that is sincere but not effusive.

Tier 2 — Informational Web Copy (website pages, event descriptions, newcomer guides). Tone is welcoming, informative, and self-explanatory. Write for readers who may know nothing about the MSA or Islam. Use short paragraphs and direct sentences. Lead with the practical answer (what, when, where) before the context. Translate or gloss religious terms. Assume global, multi-background readers.

Tier 3 — Casual Social Media (Instagram captions, story posts, group chats). Tone is friendly, lively, and human, while still respectful and never crass. Short sentences and light humor are welcome. Emoji are permitted in moderation (one to three per post). Always include the essential logistics even in a playful post. Keep faith references warm and never flippant about sacred subjects.

1.3 Transliteration Standardization

To prevent the same term being spelled three different ways across websites, flyers, and Instagram captions, the following English spellings are **locked**. These are the only permitted forms in all official MSA materials. Capitalize each as shown when used as a proper noun or event name.

Term (locked spelling)	Meaning / usage	Banned variants (do not use)
Jummah	The Friday congregational prayer and the weekly gathering around it	Jumuah, Jumu'ah, Juma, Jum'ah, Friday Prayer (as a substitute spelling)
Halaqah	A learning circle / study session, usually a short talk and discussion	Halaqa, Halqa, Halaqat, Circle
Iftar	The meal that breaks the fast at sunset during Ramadan	Ifthar, Iftaar, Eftar
Suhoor	The pre-dawn meal before the fast begins	Sehri, Sahur, Suhur, Sohoor
Musallah	The designated prayer room / prayer space	Musalla, Mossalla, Prayer Room (as a substitute spelling)
Ramadan	The month of fasting	Ramadhan, Ramzan, Ramadaan

Application rules. - On first public-facing use, follow the term with a brief parenthetical gloss as shown in 1.2 (“Jummah (the Friday congregational prayer)”). - Never mix variants within a single document or post. - When designing merchandise or signage, the design proof must be checked against this table before printing. - Additions to this table should be agreed upon by the MSA board; individual members may not introduce new locked terms unilaterally.

Note. This table governs English transliterations only. Rendering the Arabic script itself (phrases, verses, calligraphy) is governed separately — see **Section 5: Arabic Language & Sacred Text Handling**.

Section 2 — University Compliance & Logo Governance



Current logo (interim raster). The organization's mark is a square deep-red field carrying three elements: a solid black waxing crescent; white Arabic calligraphy reading salām (سلام, "peace") nested within the crescent; and a white "CMU MSA" wordmark set on a gentle arc in the upper-right. The red reads as the brand's Carnegie Red and must be standardized to #C41230 in any redraw. The calligraphy's meaning ("peace") deliberately echoes the community greeting As-salamu alaykum (see Section 5). Because the wordmark is plain typeset text — not the official CMU wordmark artwork — it is consistent with the trademark rules in Section 2.2.

Status & limitations. This guide currently embeds a temporary, low-resolution JPG placeholder. Although the MSA board has high-resolution master files (including vector/SVG copies) in their records, they have not yet been integrated. Board members should locate these master files and store them in the shared brand assets drive. Until they are integrated, avoid using the placeholder JPG for printing merchandise or creating transparent headers on websites or web platforms, as it cannot be scaled or recolored without quality loss.

2.1 SLICE Naming Compliance

The CMU Office of Student Leadership, Involvement, and Civic Engagement (SLICE) recognizes the MSA as a student organization, not as a unit or department of the university. Naming must reflect that relationship and must never imply that Carnegie Mellon University owns, operates, or formally endorses the organization.

Permitted formal names: - Muslim Student Association of Carnegie Mellon University - CMU Muslim Student Association - CMU MSA (acceptable shorthand after the full name has appeared once in a document)

Prohibited constructions: - "Carnegie Mellon Muslims" or any name dropping "Student Association," which can read as a university program. - Any name, email signature, or graphic suggesting official university sponsorship, e.g., "An official program of Carnegie Mellon University." - Standalone use of "MSA" in external or public contexts without "CMU" attached, which is ambiguous off campus.

Required usage notes. - The first reference in any formal document uses a full permitted name; subsequent references may use "CMU MSA" or "the MSA." - Email addresses and social handles should include "cmumsa" or "cmu-msa" rather than implying a university domain ownership the org does not hold. - A short disclaimer should appear in the footer of MSA websites: "The CMU Muslim Student Association is a registered student organization at Carnegie Mellon University. Views expressed are those of the organization and not of the university."

2.2 Trademark & Lettermark Rules

“Carnegie Mellon,” “Carnegie Mellon University,” “CMU,” the university seal, the official CMU wordmark, and the athletic marks are **trademarks of the university**. Their use by a student organization is permitted only within the bounds set by the university’s brand/marketing office and SLICE.

- **No co-branded lockup without approval.** The MSA’s own graphic and an official CMU wordmark must not be merged into a single combined logo (a “lockup”) without written approval from the university’s brand office. Until such approval exists, the two marks are kept visually separate.
- **The university seal is off-limits.** The CMU seal is reserved for official university use and must never appear on MSA materials, merchandise, or websites.
- **Locating, not endorsing.** Where the org needs to indicate its campus, it uses the text string “Carnegie Mellon University” as plain typeset words in the approved typeface — not the official wordmark artwork — unless the brand office has authorized wordmark use for the specific piece.
- **The MSA’s own mark is the primary identity.** The organization’s distinct logo/graphic is what appears on merchandise, banners, and website headers. The CMU reference is secondary and textual.
- **Color borrowing is allowed; mark borrowing is not.** Using Carnegie Red (Section 3) as a brand color is fine. Reproducing official university logo files is not, absent approval.
- **Annual re-confirmation.** Because these rules are set by the university and can change, the MSA board re-confirms current trademark guidance with the brand office each year and logs it here.

2.3 Logo Clear Space & Geometry

A definitive exclusion zone protects the MSA logo from visual crowding.

- **Clear-space rule.** The minimum clear space on all four sides of the logo equals **one-half of the logo’s overall width** ($W \div 2$). No other graphic element, text, photograph edge, or page margin may intrude into this zone. Example: a logo placed at 200 px wide reserves 100 px of empty space on every side.
- **Measurement origin.** “Width” is measured as the full bounding box of the complete logo artwork (mark plus any integral wordmark), not the visible glyph alone.
- **Minimum size.** The logo must never be reproduced smaller than **24 mm wide in print** or **96 px wide on screen**, to preserve legibility of fine detail. If a smaller mark is required (e.g., a favicon), use the approved simplified/icon-only variant rather than shrinking the full logo.
- **Proportional integrity.** The logo is scaled uniformly only. Never stretch, condense, skew, rotate, recolor outside the approved palette, add drop shadows or outlines, or rearrange its internal elements.
- **Placement.** Default placement is top-left of layouts (matching the web header). When centered (e.g., a banner), the clear-space rule still governs.

2.4 Monochrome & Inverted Adaptations

Three approved color treatments exist. No others are permitted.

- **Full-color (default).** Used on white or very light neutral backgrounds (Pure White or Steel Gray) and only where color reproduction is reliable. Note: the current mark already contains its own **red field**, so “full-color” placement means that red badge sits as a self-contained block on the page — it is not a transparent mark that adapts to the background. A transparent, layered vector redraw (per the

Section 2 header note) is required before the black and white single-ink variants below can be produced from it.

- **Solid black (monochrome positive).** Used when printing in a single ink, on white or light paper, on faxed/photocopied documents, or where color is unavailable. The entire mark renders in #000000 with no gray gradients; internal shapes are distinguished by knockout (white paper showing through) rather than by tints.
- **Solid white (monochrome inverted).** Used on dark backgrounds — a navy or teal hoodie, a dark banner, a photo overlay, or a dark website section. The entire mark renders in #FFFFFF. Use the inverted variant only when the background is dark enough to give the white mark a contrast ratio of at least 4.5:1 against the underlying surface.

Treatment rules. - Pick the variant by background, not by preference: light background → full-color or black; dark background → white. - Never place the full-color logo on a busy photograph. Use the solid black or solid white variant on a darkened/lightened scrim instead. - Never recolor the monochrome variants to a brand hue (no “all-teal” or “all-red” logo) unless a single-spot-color print job specifically requires it and the board approves the proof. - The icon-only simplified mark follows the same three-treatment rule.

Section 3 — The Color & Typography Systems

3.1 The Palette Hierarchy

The palette is anchored in Carnegie Red to signal the CMU campus home, balanced by a calm teal community accent, and punctuated sparingly by gold. The “volume” percentages describe the approximate share of a typical layout’s colored surface area — they are a discipline against overuse of accent colors, not a literal pixel count.

Role	Name	Hex	Semantic meaning	Target volume
Primary anchor	Carnegie Red	#C41230	Campus identity, primary calls-to-action, key headings, the brand’s heartbeat	~10–15%
Community accent	Hornbostel Teal	#1F4C4C	Calm, hospitality, community sections, secondary buttons, link/focus states	~15–20%
High-visibility highlight	Gold Thread	#FDB515	Sparing emphasis — badges, highlights, “new”/featured tags, small accents only	~3–5%
Muted secondary text	Iron Gray	#6D6E71	Captions, metadata, helper text, disabled states, fine print	~10%
Light neutral (surface)	Steel Gray	#E0E0E0	Card backgrounds, dividers, subtle fills, table stripes	~15–20%
Light neutral (base)	Pure White	#FFFFFF	Page background, primary reading surface, generous whitespace	~40–50%

Tints & shades (interactive states). The six base colors above cover the vast majority of surfaces. Five additional derived values are locked for interactive states (hover fills, ghost-button backgrounds). They are not general-purpose colors — use them only in the specific roles listed. These values are what an implementation (e.g. a Tailwind config) must reproduce exactly; do not re-derive them with a different tool.

Token name	Hex	Derived from	Locked use
cmu-red-50	#FBE9EC	Carnegie Red tint	Ghost-button hover background on light surfaces
cmu-red-700	#9E0F26	Carnegie Red shade	Hover/active state on primary (red) buttons — white text passes AA
msa-teal-50	#E7F0F0	Hornbostel Teal tint	Ghost/tertiary teal button hover background
msa-teal-700	#163838	Hornbostel Teal shade	Hover/active state on secondary (teal) buttons — white text passes AA
msa-gold-700	#D9970A	Gold Thread shade	Hover/active state on gold accent elements — black text only

Usage discipline. - **Gold is a seasoning, never a sauce.** Gold Thread is for small, deliberate accents. It is never used for body text, large fills, or any text on a light background (see 3.2). - **Red leads, teal supports.** Carnegie Red carries the primary action and brand presence; Hornbostel Teal handles the bulk of secondary UI and community-themed sections. - **Neutrals do the heavy lifting.** White dominates; Steel Gray separates and groups; Iron Gray quiets secondary text. - **Black for body text.** Long-form body copy is near-black (#1A1A1A or #000000) on white, not a brand hue.

3.2 WCAG Accessibility Contrast Matrix

All combinations were computed against the WCAG 2.1 relative-luminance formula. Thresholds: AA normal text $\geq 4.5:1$, AA large text (≥ 24 px, or ≥ 19 px bold) $\geq 3:1$, AAA normal text $\geq 7:1$. “Large only” means the pairing is legal only at large text sizes; it is **banned for normal body text**. “BANNED” means the pairing fails even at large sizes and must never carry text (decorative-only, never typographic).

Foreground text on background — ratios and verdicts:

Text color ↓ / Background →	White #FFF	Steel Gray #E0E0E0	Carnegie Red #C41230	Hornbostel Teal #1F4C4C	Gold Thread #FDB515	Black #000
Carnegie Red	6.04 — [OK] AA / AAA-large	4.58 — [OK] AA	—	1.58 — [BANNED]	3.39 — [!] large only	3.48 — [!] large only
Hornbostel Teal	9.56 — [OK] AAA	7.24 — [OK] AAA	1.58 — [BANNED]	—	5.37 — [OK] AA / AAA-large	2.20 — [BANNED]
Gold Thread	1.78 — [BANNED]	1.35 — [BANNED]	3.39 — [!] large only	5.37 — [OK] AA / AAA-large	—	11.80 — [OK] AAA
Iron Gray	5.10 — [OK] AA / AAA-large	3.86 — [!] large only	1.18 — [BANNED]	1.88 — [BANNED]	2.86 — [BANNED]	4.12 — [!] large only
Pure White	—	1.32 — [BANNED]	6.04 — [OK] AA / AAA-large	9.56 — [OK] AAA	1.78 — [BANNED]	21.00 — [OK] AAA
Black	21.00 — [OK] AAA	15.91 — [OK] AAA	3.48 — [!] large only	2.20 — [BANNED]	11.80 — [OK] AAA	—

Locked rules drawn from the matrix:

- **[OK] Approved primary pairings (use freely):** White text on Hornbostel Teal (9.56, AAA); White on Carnegie Red (6.04 — body OK, but treat headings as the strong case); Hornbostel Teal text on White (9.56) and on Steel Gray (7.24); Black on Gold Thread (11.80) — the **only** approved way to put text near gold; White on Black; Black on White.
- **[BANNED] Hard bans (never place this text on this background, any size):** Gold Thread on White, Gold Thread on Steel Gray, White on Steel Gray, Carnegie Red on Teal, Teal on Red, Teal on Black, Iron Gray on Red/Teal/Gold. Gold-on-white in particular is forbidden — the example everyone gets wrong.
- **[!] Large-text-only (headings/ ≥ 24 px, never body):** Carnegie Red on Black, Carnegie Red on Gold, Black on Carnegie Red, Iron Gray on Steel Gray. If in doubt, do not use these for anything a user must read carefully.
- **Gold + text = black, on gold.** Because gold fails against every light surface, the org never sets gold-colored text on light backgrounds. When gold appears with text, the gold is the background and the text is black.
- **Body text default:** near-black on White or on Steel Gray. Iron Gray is acceptable for secondary/body on White (5.10) but must not be used on colored backgrounds.

3.3 Typography Stack

Two accessible, screen-legible families used by the university ecosystem, with locked weights and roles.

Headings / Display — Open Sans. - Allowed weights: **Bold 700** (primary headings, hero titles, buttons) and **Semi-Bold 600** (subheadings, card titles, navigation). - Use sentence case for most UI; reserve all-caps for small labels/eyebrows with letter-spacing (tracking-wide). - Web fallback stack: 'Open Sans', system-ui, -apple-system, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, Arial, sans-serif.

Body / Long-form — Source Serif Pro. - Allowed weights: **Regular 400** (default body, paragraphs, article text) and **Medium 500** (lead paragraphs, pull quotes, emphasis within body). - Line height for body: 1.6–1.7; measure (line length) capped around 65–75 characters for readability. - Web fallback stack: 'Source Serif Pro', Georgia, 'Times New Roman', serif.

Type-scale (recommended baseline, rem):

Token	Size	Family / weight	Use
Display	3rem (48px)	Open Sans 700	Hero / page title
H1	2.25rem (36px)	Open Sans 700	Page heading
H2	1.75rem (28px)	Open Sans 600	Section heading
H3	1.375rem (22px)	Open Sans 600	Card / subsection
Body	1.0625rem (17px)	Source Serif Pro 400	Paragraph text
Lead	1.25rem (20px)	Source Serif Pro 500	Intro paragraph
Small	0.875rem (14px)	Open Sans 400	Labels, metadata

Rules. Never mix more than these two families. Do not use Open Sans weights below 600 for headings or above 400 weight tricks for fake bolding — load the real weights. Body copy never drops below 16px on screen.

Section 4 — Web & Digital UI Standards

4.1 Design Tokens (values)

These are the canonical interface values every implementation must use. They are framework-neutral. Color hex codes and the type scale are defined in Section 3 — this subsection adds the non-color interface tokens.

Token	Value	Use
Corner radius (standard)	12px (rounded-xl)	Cards, buttons, inputs, images, modals
Corner radius (small)	6px	Chips, badges
Transition duration	200ms	All interactive state changes
Transition easing	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)	Standard ease
Focus ring	3px, Hornbostel Teal (#1F4C4C)	Keyboard focus on every interactive element

Named typography tokens an implementation should expose: heading → Open Sans; body → Source Serif Pro; arabic → Amiri / Noto Naskh Arabic; arabic-quran → Amiri Quran; arabic-heading → Cairo / Noto Sans Arabic. Color tokens map to the palette in Section 3.

These tokens should be implemented directly in MSA websites' configuration/styling. This brand guide defines the values; any digital platform implementation should apply them.

4.2 Interactive States

A single, consistent interaction language across MSA web properties. The behaviour described is the requirement; the Tailwind classes shown are examples of how this can be expressed in styles.

- **Timing.** All interactive transitions use **200ms** duration with the standard ease cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1). In Tailwind: `transition duration-200 ease-in-out` (the config sets these as defaults, so `transition` alone suffices).
- **Primary button (Carnegie Red).**
 - Rest: `bg-cmu-red text-white font-heading rounded-xl px-5 py-2.5`
 - Hover: `hover:bg-cmu-red-700` (darken)
 - Focus:
`focus:outline-none focus-visible:ring-3 focus-visible:ring-msa-teal focus-visible:ring-offset-2`
 - Active/pressed: slight scale-down `active:scale-[0.98]`
 - Disabled: `disabled:bg-steel-gray disabled:text-iron-gray disabled:cursor-not-allowed`
- **Secondary button (Hornbostel Teal).** Same geometry; `bg-msa-teal text-white hover:bg-msa-teal-700`, same teal focus ring with offset so the ring stays visible against the teal fill.
- **Tertiary / ghost button.** `bg-transparent text-msa-teal border border-msa-teal hover:bg-msa-teal-50`.

- **Links.** `text-msa-teal underline-offset-2 hover:underline hover:text-msa-teal-700 focus-visible:ring-3 focus-visible:ring-msa-teal rounded-sm`. Visited links keep the same color (no separate visited hue) to preserve brand consistency.
- **Text inputs.** `rounded-xl border border-steel-gray bg-white px-3 py-2 text-[17px] focus:outline-none focus-visible:ring-3 focus-visible:ring-msa-teal focus-visible:border-msa-teal`. Error state: `border-cmu-red ring-cmu-red; helper/error text in text-cmu-red text-sm`.
- **Focus is never removed.** `outline-none` is permitted only when immediately paired with a visible `focus-visible:ring-*`. Keyboard focus must always be visible (accessibility requirement, non-negotiable).
- **Reduced motion.** Respect the user setting: wrap non-essential animation so it is disabled under `motion-reduce:transition-none`.

4.3 Containers & Visual Motifs

- **Corner rounding.** The canonical radius is **rounded-xl (12px)** for cards, buttons, inputs, images, and modals. Smaller chips/badges may use `rounded-md (6px)`; fully-round pills use `rounded-full` for tags only. No sharp 0px corners on interactive containers; no oversized radii beyond 12px on standard cards.
- **Card component (standard).** A content card is a white surface with a 1px Steel Gray border, a **4px left accent border** colour-coded per the rule below, 12px corners (`rounded-xl`), comfortable padding, and a subtle shadow that deepens on hover.
- **Left-border markers (`border-l-4`).** Content cards and callouts are separated and categorized by a 4px left accent border, not by heavy boxes. Color encodes category: **Carnegie Red** = primary/featured, **Hornbostel Teal** = community/standard, **Gold Thread** = highlighted/"new" (used sparingly). The rest of the card border stays a quiet `steel-gray`.
- **Geometric line motifs.** Thin 1px Steel Gray rules (`border-t border-steel-gray`) separate sections; avoid heavy dividers. Optional subtle geometric line ornament (e.g., a single thin teal rule under section headings) is permitted but must never reduce text contrast.
- **Spacing & whitespace.** Generous whitespace is part of the brand (calm, hospitable). Default section padding `py-12 md:py-16`; card padding `p-6`. Do not crowd.
- **Shadows.** Subtle only: `shadow-sm` at rest, `shadow-md` on hover. No hard or colored drop shadows.

Section 5 — Arabic Language & Sacred Text Handling

MSA digital platforms and websites are English-primary but **Arabic-forward in selected places** — section headers, key phrases, and decorative calligraphy. These rules govern any Arabic that appears on MSA web and digital channels. Permitted Arabic content: short phrases (Bismillah, As-salamu alaykum, common du'as), Quranic verses (ayat), Hadith, and decorative calligraphy. Arabic functions as emphasis and identity, not as the primary reading layer.

5.1 Directionality & Layout (RTL)

- Arabic is rendered as **inline right-to-left elements inside the left-to-right English page**, by setting `dir="rtl"` and `lang="ar"` on the specific element (a `<span>`, heading, or block) — **never** on the whole `<html>` document.
- Use **CSS logical properties** (`margin-inline`, `padding-inline`, `text-align: start/end`) so mixed-direction layouts don't break.
- Do not make an entire website RTL unless and until a dedicated full-Arabic version is built (out of scope for now).
- Within Arabic passages, use Arabic punctuation where natural (, comma, ؟ question mark). Dates and times in English context use Western digits (0–9).

5.2 Typefaces

- **Arabic body & sacred text** → **Amiri** (a Naskh face designed for exactly this). For **Quranic ayat specifically**, use the **Amiri Quran** cut, which is built for full vocalization.
- **Arabic headings/display** → **Cairo** (or Noto Sans Arabic) to harmonize with the Open Sans Latin headings.
- **Decorative calligraphy** (Thuluth, Diwani, etc.) is produced or licensed as **artwork** — **SVG preferred, high-resolution raster acceptable** — **never set as a live webfont**. This avoids cross-device rendering failures. Every calligraphy image carries descriptive `alt` text (transliteration + meaning) and a visible caption.
- Load the real Arabic font weights; never fake bold or simulate diacritics.
- Typography tokens are defined in Section 4.1: `arabic`, `arabic-quran`, and `arabic-heading`.

5.3 Diacritics (Tashkeel)

- **Quranic ayat**: full tashkeel **required**, transcribed to match a reliable mushaf.
- **Short du'as / phrases**: tashkeel recommended.
- **Names and UI labels**: tashkeel optional.

5.4 Sacred Text — Sourcing, Accuracy & Citation

- **Inclusion is at the author's discretion** — there is no mandatory pre-publication sign-off.
- **Citation is mandatory** whenever Quran or Hadith appears:
- **Quran**: Surah name + (chapter:verse), e.g., Al-Fatihah (1:1). Quote verbatim from a reliable mushaf; never paraphrase the Arabic of a verse.

- **Hadith:** collection + reference number, plus the grading where known, e.g., Sahih al-Bukhari 1.
- **Accuracy duty.** Even under author's discretion, the author is responsible for transcribing sacred text correctly — every letter and every tashkeel mark. When unsure, verify against a trusted printed or established digital source before publishing. Errors in sacred text are corrected as a first priority (fix promptly, no debate).
- **English accompaniment is at the author's discretion.** A translation and/or transliteration may accompany Arabic but is not required. When a translation is shown, attribute the translation source (e.g., translator name or edition).

5.5 Honorifics

- Use **English abbreviations**, not Arabic glyphs, for consistency on English-primary digital platforms:
- After the Prophet Muhammad → **(PBUH)** — locked as the house standard. (SAW is an acceptable alternative only in casual community-facing social posts; pick one per piece and stay consistent.)
- After a companion → **(RA)**.
- After a prophet → **(AS)**.
- Place the honorific immediately after the name on first and other significant mentions.
- **Do not** use the Arabic honorific glyph (e.g., ﷺ) in body text — it renders inconsistently across devices and fonts. It is acceptable only when it appears inside licensed calligraphy artwork.

5.6 Accessibility for Arabic

- Every Arabic element carries `lang="ar"` so screen readers switch pronunciation correctly.
- Calligraphy images require `alt` text giving the transliteration and meaning.
- Color-contrast rules from Section 3.2 still apply; ornate or fine scripts need a larger size or heavier weight to stay legible — when in doubt, increase size rather than thicken contrast-failing colors.

This document is the single source of truth; where any flyer, page, or component disagrees with it, this brand guide governs and the artifact is corrected.